

Farming

Good food from your own garden helps children grow strong and helps everyone fight sickness. Eat foods from many food groups every day.

For community members

Key messages

- Eat foods from as many of the eight food groups as you can every day.
- Plant a garden with green leafy vegetables like aibika and fern greens, orange and yellow vegetables and fruits like pumpkin, carrot and pawpaw, beans and peanuts, and a staple like kaukau, taro or cassava. Keep chickens or other animals for eggs and meat if you can.
- The first 1,000 days, from pregnancy to a child's second birthday, are the most important for growth and learning.
- Children aged 6 to 23 months should eat at least five of the eight groups every day.

- Pregnant and breastfeeding women should eat a variety of foods and avoid smoking and alcohol.
- Wash your hands before preparing food, and cover drinking water.
- Sell extra produce for school fees, medicine and transport.

Take your child to the health centre if they

- Are very thin, or have swollen feet
- Are not growing or gaining weight
- Have no energy and do not want to eat
- Have diarrhoea that does not stop

The eight food groups

- Breast milk (to 2 years or more)
- Grains, roots and tubers: rice, kaukau, taro, cassava, sago
- Beans, peas, nuts and seeds: peanuts, beans
- Dairy products

- Flesh foods: meat, fish, chicken
- Eggs
- Vitamin A rich fruits and vegetables: pumpkin, carrot, pawpaw, ripe mango, dark green leaves
- Other fruits and vegetables

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.